SELF CONFIDENCE



SEAN PUBLICATION

ISMAIL KAMDAR

AMOL BOOKS

IN THE NAME OF

ALLAH

THE ALL-COMPASSIONATE, ALL-MERCIFUL



Self-confidence

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ABU MUAWIYAH ISMAIL KAMDAR

Sean Publication Ltd.

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Publisher's Note

It was not too long ago that a younger lad dressed in cargos, a full sleeve tee and a pair of converse with a cap to go with it, had found himself wandering the streets of Baridhara in search of the premises of SEAN PUBLICATION. There were jitters in his stomach and his throat was dry. He was clueless as to why he felt so tense. All he had to do was step in, pay for the books he ordered and leave. Pins and needle, just over having to make conversation! Track the reel three years into the future and that very same lad, me, sits and wonders how much I would have benefited had I come across this beneficial book.

From clearing our misconceptions of how confidence is not to be woven with arrogance to how humility is not being in tatters and voiceless- this book is the apt guide to self-searching and augmenting one's potential. It convinces that through being confident and successful Muslims who do not cower at the onset of challenges, one can play a part in making the ummah successful like the early generations.

Ismail Kamdar, through "Self-confidence", teaches us to stop dragging ourselves and instead trains us to trudge along in life.

Abu Yousuf Obaid
Operation manager

Importance of Self-Confidence

A long time ago, the world's most powerful empire was the Muslim empire. It was a nation full of scholars, doctors, scientists, ethical businessmen and genius inventors. The early Muslim nation was founded by confident individuals, who trusted Allah's plan, using their God-given talents to make this world a better place.

But somewhere down the line, things changed. The Ummah declined until it became a shell of its former self. And then it broke into many fragmented pieces. This was followed by a generation of followers and imitators, low in confidence and self-esteem, feeling inferior to the West, following and never daring to lead.

The ummah lost its confidence, but we can get it back by returning to our roots and going back to that which made the early generations so successful, the Qur'an and Sunnah[1]

Self-Confidence is a word that means different things to different people. For many, it is a positive word indicating a strong courageous person who does things others are afraid to do. For some, however, it refers to an arrogant know-it-all who thinks he is better than the rest. This is due to a misconception that self-confidence is a synonym for arrogance.

I will address this misconception in details in the second chapter. For now, understand that this book is based on the positive definition that most people accept. Self-Confidence is the belief that you are capable of doing the things you want to do and need to do, and that you are essentially a good person who has

1 Lifestyle and teachings of Prophet Muhammad (peace be upon him) found in narrations called Hadith.

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the ability to contribute to society and make a difference in this world.

Self-Confidence is a crucial factor for success in both worlds and we need it for many reasons which include the following:

- To practice Islam confidently in a world were practicing Muslims feel strange
- To repent from sin and try harder to be righteous, without giving up
- To do Dawah effectively, as it takes confidence to present the message of Islam to people who might reject it
- To be able to study Islam and present it confidently to others
- To be confident enough to chase our dreams and goals
- To be able to work efficiently and productively
- To improve our relationships, especially marital relationships
- To be able to deal with doubts, criticisms and negative talk
- To become more independent and dependable
- To unleash your potential and be the best you can be
- To become comfortable with yourself, your flaws and your mistakes
- To live life without fear of what people will say
- To be yourself and be true to yourself

Without doubt, there are dozens of benefits of being self-confident and there are dozens of books published on this topic too. So you might be wondering what makes this book different.

As Muslims, there are a few key beliefs and principles we hold that make us view self-confidence and the methods of attaining it in a different light from others.

Secular[2] thinkers tend to look at humans as the most important beings in existence. They look at the attainment of our own

2 I use secular here to refer to thinkers who approach this topic from a non-religious

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desires as the purpose of our lives. The Islamic perspective is very different as we view ourselves as servants of Allah working towards earning His Pleasure through obeying His Law.

This creates a vastly different perspective in how we approach self-confidence. We do not look at ourselves as self-serving, but as servants of Allah. This means our confidence in our own abilities comes from our confidence in Our Creator, How He made us, and What He has promised us.

In this sense, the Islamic perspective on self-confidence is even more empowering. We do not rely only on our own capabilities to accomplish our goals, but we know that Allah has promised to help us in ways that we can never imagine, and so in pursuit of our goals, miracles are possible!

While the secular perspective is based on belief in oneself, the Islamic perspective is based in belief in Allah as the Best of Creators and the belief that humans are one of His Greatest Creations. It is based on gratitude to Allah, reliance on Him and a desire to work towards and live for a higher purpose.

The Islamic perspective does not just differ in terms of worldview, but also in terms of methods. As Muslims, we can only use Halal or Islamic methods to increase our self-confidence and must avoid any Haraam suggestions that can be found in the writings on Non-Muslims.

For example, it is common to hear people today claiming that a "one night stand"[3] can do wonders for your self-confidence, but as Muslims we must reject such claims and never dare to do such an evil deed. Our confidence comes from our relationship with Allah, and so any act that breaks our covenant with Allah

perspective, even if they do follow a religion in their private lives.

3. Refers to a night of fornication with a stranger with no emotional attachment. Sadly, this is actually something that some secular thinkers encourage to increase self-confidence.

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cannot increase our confidence. Rather, such acts bring about feelings of shame and regret which are confidence killers.

In this book, we will explore the main sources of confidence for Muslims which can be summarizes as:

1. Our Relationship with Allah
2. Our beliefs about ourselves
3. Our Attitude towards the world
4. Our circle of friends
5. How we deal with mistakes, tests and setbacks
6. How we handle fear
7. Our Ability to step outside our comfort zones

Each of these concepts will be explained in details with evidences and tips, and each section is followed by action points as this is a practical book and you can only benefit from it if you practice on its teachings. After exploring all of this, the final chapter will be a set of general tips on how to increase your self-confidence and stay motivated.

We will also discuss common pitfalls that cause loss of self-confidence like negative self-talk, toxic company and bad life experiences, as well as how to deal with them and rise above them.

Allah has created humans and He declared that we are among the best of Creation. He has given us an important role to play as His representatives on earth. In order to do justice to that role, we will have to challenge social norms, step outside our comfort zones, deal with rejection and often times speak in public. All of these require a lot of confidence, and this book will help you learn the right attitudes, tools and beliefs to assist you in doing this.

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